BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #1 · CHRONIC ILLNESS

"My body has betrayed me."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

A diagnosis, a flare, or a body that no longer cooperates can feel like treachery from the one thing we thought we could count on. Anger and grief at the body are natural, and over time they can turn into resentment, fear, or a sense of being at war with ourselves.

What Scripture teaches

The psalmist says, "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made." Paul writes, "Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day." "My flesh and my heart may fail, but God is the strength of my heart and my portion forever." Our bodies live in a fallen world and wear down, but they are still gifts from God and we are still His. You can grieve what has been lost without making your body the enemy.

> *"I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well"* (Psalm 139:14).

Also see

> "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day" (2 Corinthians 4:16).

> "My flesh and my heart may fail, but God is the strength of my heart and my portion forever" (Psalm 73:26).

> "Do you not know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit who is in you, whom you have received from God? You are not your own; you were bought at a price. Therefore glorify God with your body" (1 Corinthians 6:19–20).

> "As a father has compassion on his children, so the LORD has compassion on those who fear Him. For He knows our frame; He is mindful that we are dust" (Psalm 103:13–14).

Common self-statements

- My body is the enemy.
- It let me down.
- I cannot trust it anymore.
- I am at war with myself.
- It is ruining my life.
- I hate what it has become.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing my body as either perfect or traitor.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that my body will keep failing.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling let down and concluding it is hostile.
- Labeling: Calling my body a betrayer.

Challenging questions

- What did I expect my body to do that it can no longer do?
- What am I grieving?

- What does my body still do for me each day?
- How would I speak to a friend whose body is failing?
- What does Scripture say about the body in a fallen world?
- What would it look like to be gentle with my body?

Truth summary

> My body is part of a fallen world, yet it is God's gift and I am His. I can grieve my losses, care for my body kindly, and trust God as the strength of my heart.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Sickness
- Suffering
- God, Creator
- Gifts, Physical/Material
- Hardship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My body has betrayed me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My body has betrayed me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did I expect my body to do that it can no longer do?
- ☐ What am I grieving?
- ☐ What does my body still do for me each day?
- ☐ How would I speak to a friend whose body is failing?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about the body in a fallen world?
- ☐ What would it look like to be gentle with my body?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ My inner self is renewed daily.
- ☐ God is the strength of my heart.
- ☐ My body is a gift to steward.
- ☐ Grief is not betrayal.
- ☐ I can be gentle with myself.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 139:14
  "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 4:16
  "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day."
- ☐ Psalm 73:26
  "My flesh and my heart may fail, but God is the strength of my heart and my portion forever."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Gentle with my body: Each day, thank God for one thing your body did.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 139:14 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am fearfully and wonderfully made, even when my body struggles.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Sickness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Name the grief. Write what you have lost.
- [ ] Thank your body. List ten things it still does.
- [ ] Follow medical care. Keep appointments and treatment plans.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 73:26. Say it on hard days.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My body has betrayed me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Gentle with my body
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My body has betrayed me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, my body has changed and I am angry and afraid. Teach me to grieve honestly, care for it gently, and rely on You as the strength of my heart. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #2 · CHRONIC ILLNESS

“I am nothing but my illness.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Appointments, symptoms, medication schedules, and other people’s questions can make illness the center of life. The label can replace the name. Over time, we may stop seeing ourselves as a person who happens to be sick and start seeing a patient, a case, or a problem.

What Scripture teaches

God knew you before any diagnosis: “You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb” (Psalm 139:13). Jesus said, “Even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows.” Paul says, “Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation.” Your identity is a child of God, loved, gifted, and called. Illness is something you have, not who you are.

> *“For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb”* (Psalm 139:13).

Also see

> “And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows” (Luke 12:7).

> “Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!” (2 Corinthians 5:17).

> “For we are God’s workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life” (Ephesians 2:10).

> “I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:14).

Common self-statements

- I am just a patient.
- My illness defines me.
- Nothing else about me matters.
- People only see my condition.
- I am my diagnosis.
- I have no identity apart from this.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either well or defined by illness.
- Fortune telling: Predicting I will never be more than a patient.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling consumed and concluding that I am the illness.
- Labeling: Calling myself my diagnosis.

Challenging questions

- What did I enjoy and value before this illness?

- What parts of me are not touched by it?
- Who sees me as more than my diagnosis?
- What does God call me?
- What small activity can remind me who I am?
- How could I introduce myself without mentioning my illness?

Truth summary

> I am a person loved by God, with gifts, relationships, and purpose. My illness is part of my story, not the whole of it.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Sickness
- God, Creator
- Love, By God
- Suffering

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Weak/Tired

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I am nothing but my illness"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I am nothing but my illness." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did I enjoy and value before this illness?
- ☐ What parts of me are not touched by it?
- ☐ Who sees me as more than my diagnosis?
- ☐ What does God call me?
- ☐ What small activity can remind me who I am?
- ☐ How could I introduce myself without mentioning my illness?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am known by God by name.
- ☐ I am worth more than many sparrows.
- ☐ I am a new creation in Christ.
- ☐ I was made for good works.
- ☐ I am more than my diagnosis.
- ☐ My story is larger than this.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 139:13
  "For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb."
- ☐ Luke 12:7
  "And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 5:17
  "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] More than my diagnosis: Each week, note one thing you did or enjoyed that was not about illness.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 139:13 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am a child of God, not a diagnosis.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List who you are. Write ten things true of you apart from illness.
- [ ] Do one thing you love. Choose an activity within your abilities.
- [ ] Tell someone. Share a part of you that is not about health.
- [ ] Memorize Luke 12:7. Say it when the label feels too big.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I am nothing but my illness": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	More than my diagnosis
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I am nothing but my illness.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You know me by name, not by a diagnosis. Remind me who I am in You, and help me enjoy what remains of me and my life. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #3 · CHRONIC ILLNESS

“I will never feel well again.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Long illness wears down hope. After many treatments, setbacks, and bad days, the mind starts to treat the present as permanent. Even good days feel like a pause before the next crash.

What Scripture teaches

“Therefore we do not lose heart.” Scripture says, “He gives power to the faint and increases the strength of the weak… those who wait upon the LORD will renew their strength.” “Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning” (Psalm 30:5). We cannot promise a medical outcome, but we can say that the future is not yours to see and that God holds it. Better and worse days are still ahead, and God is with you in each.

> *“He gives power to the faint and increases the strength of the weak. Even youths grow tired and weary, and young men stumble and fall. But those who wait upon the LORD will renew their strength; they will mount up with wings like eagles; they will run and not grow weary, they will walk and not faint”* (Isaiah 40:29–31).

Also see

> “Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day” (2 Corinthians 4:16).

> “For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning” (Psalm 30:5).

> “Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!” (Lamentations 3:22–23).

> “I consider that our present sufferings are not comparable to the glory that will be revealed in us” (Romans 8:18).

Common self-statements

- This will never end.
- I will always feel this way.
- There is no hope for recovery.
- Good days are a trick.
- What is the point of trying?
- I have already tried everything.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I will either be fully well or never improve.
- Fortune telling: Predicting a permanent future.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling terrible and concluding that I always will.
- Labeling: Calling myself hopeless.

Challenging questions

- What has actually changed over time, even a little?
- What good days have I had, and what made them better?
- What do my doctors honestly say about the outlook?
- What does hope mean if the outcome is uncertain?
- What does Scripture promise about God's presence and renewal?
- What is one thing that helps today?

Truth summary

> I cannot see the future, and neither can my feelings. God gives strength to the weak, and I can hope in Him one day at a time, whatever my health brings.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Sickness
- Suffering
- Faith
- Tired

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I will never feel well again"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I will never feel well again." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What has actually changed over time, even a little?
- ☐ What good days have I had, and what made them better?
- ☐ What do my doctors honestly say about the outlook?
- ☐ What does hope mean if the outcome is uncertain?
- ☐ What does Scripture promise about God's presence and renewal?
- ☐ What is one thing that helps today?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God gives power to the faint.
- ☐ Those who wait on Him renew strength.
- ☐ Weeping may last the night; joy comes.
- ☐ His mercies are new every morning.
- ☐ I do not lose heart.
- ☐ Today is enough to face.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Isaiah 40:29–31
  "He gives power to the faint and increases the strength of the weak. Even youths grow tired and weary, and young men stumble and fall. But those who wait upon the LORD will renew their strength; they will mount up with wings like eagles; they will run and not grow weary, they will walk and not faint."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 4:16
  "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day."
- ☐ Psalm 30:5
  "For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Today's strength: Each day, note one thing that went better than expected.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Isaiah 40:29–31 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God gives power to the faint and renews my strength.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Track good moments. Write down better hours or days.
- ☐ Ask your doctor. Discuss realistic goals and what helps.
- ☐ Plan small joys. Schedule something gentle each day.
- ☐ Read Lamentations 3:22–23. Receive fresh mercy each morning.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I will never feel well again": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Today's strength
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I will never feel well again.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am weary of being unwell. Give strength to the faint, renew me day by day, and keep hope alive in me whatever comes. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #4 · CHRONIC ILLNESS

“I am a burden to everyone.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Needing help with meals, driving, chores, or finances can make us feel like a weight on those we love. Guilt grows, and some people withdraw so as not to “bother” anyone. Often loved ones say they want to help, but the belief persists.

What Scripture teaches

Paul writes, “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ,” which assumes that all of us have burdens and all of us help carry them. Paul says “the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable” (1 Corinthians 12:22). Jesus welcomed those who needed help and said, “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened.” Receiving care is a gift that lets others love.

> *“Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ”* (Galatians 6:2).

Also see

> “On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable” (1 Corinthians 12:22).

> “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest” (Matthew 11:28).

> “Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!” (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10).

> “Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep” (Romans 12:15).

Common self-statements

- They would be better off without me.
- I am costing them too much.
- I should not ask for help.
- I am a weight on my family.
- They are tired of me.
- I wish I did not need anyone.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing myself as either independent or a burden.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that people will resent me.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling guilty and concluding that I am a burden.
- Mind reading: Calling myself a burden.

Challenging questions

- What do my loved ones actually say about helping me?
- What would I feel if I could help someone I love in this situation?
- What do I still give to others?
- What does Scripture say about weaker members?

- How could I accept help in a way that lets others give?
- Who could I speak with if the thought of being a burden becomes heavy?

Truth summary

> I am valuable to God and to the people who love me, not because of what I do for them. Receiving help is part of how love works, and my presence is a gift. If dark thoughts come, I will tell someone right away.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Sickness
- Friendship
- Love, For Others
- Loneliness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I am a burden to everyone"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I am a burden to everyone." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do my loved ones actually say about helping me?
- ☐ What would I feel if I could help someone I love in this situation?
- ☐ What do I still give to others?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about weaker members?
- ☐ How could I accept help in a way that lets others give?
- ☐ Who could I speak with if the thought of being a burden becomes heavy?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ We carry one another's burdens.
- ☐ Weaker parts are indispensable.
- ☐ Jesus welcomes the weary.
- ☐ Two are better than one.
- ☐ Receiving is a gift to others.
- ☐ I am loved as I am.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:22
  "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable."
- ☐ Matthew 11:28
  "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Receiving love: Each week, note one time you received help gracefully.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Galatians 6:2 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Weaker parts of the body are indispensable, and so am I.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Ask loved ones. Tell them what you fear and listen to their answer.
- [ ] Say thank you. Receive help without apologizing.
- [ ] Give what you can. Offer a prayer, a call, or a kind word.
- [ ] If you ever feel life is not worth living, call or text 988 (U.S.) now. Tell someone close to you.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I am a burden to everyone": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Receiving love
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I am a burden to everyone.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel like a weight on those I love. Show me that I am valued, teach me to receive with grace, and let my life bless others in ways I cannot see. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #5 · CHRONIC ILLNESS

"My life is over."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

A serious diagnosis or permanent change can feel like the end of the life we knew: work, plans, roles, and dreams. Grief for that life is real. But grief can slide into believing that nothing meaningful remains.

What Scripture teaches

"For I know the plans I have for you," declares the LORD (Jeremiah 29:11). Paul writes, "Therefore we do not lose heart… our light and momentary affliction is producing for us an eternal weight of glory." "In old age they will still bear fruit" (Psalm 92:14), and the psalmist asks God not to forsake him "until I proclaim Your power to the next generation." Your old life may be over, but your life is not. God is not finished with you.

> *"Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day. For our light and momentary affliction is producing for us an eternal weight of glory that is far beyond comparison. So we fix our eyes not on what is seen, but on what is unseen. For what is seen is temporary, but what is unseen is eternal"* (2 Corinthians 4:16–18).

Also see

> "Even when I am old and gray, do not forsake me, O God, until I proclaim Your power to the next generation, Your might to all who are to come" (Psalm 71:18).

> "Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus" (Philippians 1:6).

> "In old age they will still bear fruit; healthy and green they will remain" (Psalm 92:14).

> "Now this is what the LORD says— He who created you, O Jacob, and He who formed you, O Israel: 'Do not fear, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by your name; you are Mine! When you pass through the waters, I will be with you; and when you go through the rivers, they will not overwhelm you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be scorched; the flames will not set you ablaze.'" (Isaiah 43:1–2).

Common self-statements

- Everything good is behind me.
- There is nothing left to live for.
- I am just waiting for the end.
- I have no purpose now.
- My dreams are dead.
- Nothing I do matters.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing life is either full or over.
- Fortune telling: Predicting nothing good will come.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling devastated and concluding that life is finished.

- Labeling: Calling myself finished.

Challenging questions

- What exactly have I lost, and what remains?
- What new things could I still do or give, even in small ways?
- Who needs what I can still offer?
- What does Scripture say about God's plans and purposes?
- What would I tell a friend in my situation?
- What is one meaningful thing I can do this week?

Truth summary

> A season of my life may have ended, but my life has not. God is not finished with me, and He can give new purpose and meaning in my new circumstances. If hopeless thoughts become heavy, I will reach out for help right away.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Suffering
- Will of God
- Sickness
- Depression, Symptoms of

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My life is over"

✦ ✦ ✦

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"My life is over." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

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The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What exactly have I lost, and what remains?
- ☐ What new things could I still do or give, even in small ways?
- ☐ Who needs what I can still offer?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about God's plans and purposes?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend in my situation?
- ☐ What is one meaningful thing I can do this week?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I do not lose heart.
- ☐ God will finish the work He began.
- ☐ I can still bear fruit.
- ☐ God has not forsaken me.
- ☐ New purposes are possible.
- ☐ My life still matters.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **2 Corinthians 4:16–18**
  "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day. For our light and momentary affliction is producing for us an eternal weight of glory that is far beyond comparison. So we fix our eyes not on what is seen, but on what is unseen. For what is seen is temporary, but what is unseen is eternal."
- ☐ **Psalm 71:18**
  "Even when I am old and gray, do not forsake me, O God, until I proclaim Your power to the next generation, Your might to all who are to come."
- ☐ **Philippians 1:6**
  "Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

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6 My action step this week

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- ☐ Grieve honestly. Write what you have lost.
- ☐ List what remains. Write what you can still do.
- ☐ Serve in a small way. Pray, write, call, encourage.
- ☐ If you think of ending your life, call or text 988 (U.S.) now. Tell someone right away.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My life is over": _____ % My truth: _____ %

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After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

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My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My life is over.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, a life I knew has ended. Comfort my grief, and show me the purposes You still have for me. Do not let me lose heart. Amen.

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